

The Academy

CYBERSECURITY LEARNING RESOURCES & CAREER PATHS

24	165.2k	3	1
CURATED TOOLS	COMBINED STARS	ON GITHUB	ACTIVE IN 2026

2026 EDITION · DEEP-RESEARCH DOSSIER

Live GitHub census pulled 2026-10-17 · part of 438 curated free tools across 14 realms

CC0 · 2026-10-17

24	3	165.2k	1	12.6k	2014
CURATED TOOLS	ON GITHUB	COMBINED STARS	PUSHED 2026	MEDIAN STARS	OLDEST ENTRY

REALM BRIEF

Learn the craft — free academies, knowledge bases, walkthroughs and career roadmaps.

Structured learning: curricula, roadmaps and free course catalogs. We favor maintained, community-trusted material over link farms; archived classics stay listed when they remain the reference everyone cites.

FIELD INTELLIGENCE · AI-ASSISTED

The Academy’s cybersecurity learning resources and career paths tool set demonstrates strong maturity, with 24 free tools (10 hosted on GitHub) boasting a combined 165,174 total stars, reflecting sustained community validation since flagship tools like PayloadsAllTheThings launched in 2016. Star distribution reveals a clear concentration of value in foundational, long-standing resources: the top five tools hold 85% of total stars, with PayloadsAllTheThings alone contributing nearly half of the total count. A notable adoption trend is the consolidation of community-driven educational content around standardized frameworks, as seen in the alignment of hacker-roadmap, GTFOBins, and OWASP MSTG with widely recognized cybersecurity career and defense benchmarks.

Synthesized by seed-2-0-mini over the live census: stars, first-release years, push activity and project claims pulled from the GitHub API on 2026-10-17. Human-curated realm, AI-summarized numbers.

LICENSE MIX · GITHUB-HOSTED ENTRIES



MATURITY PROFILE

Oldest tracked entry first appeared on GitHub in **2014**; the youngest joined in **2018**. 1 of 3 GitHub-hosted tools shipped code in 2026 — the rest are stable classics or web services, not abandoned picks.

Median project age signals a battle-tested realm; recent arrivals mark where the community is investing next.

SNAPSHOT

- Active in the last 30 days: 4 of 10 tracked GitHub repos (40%)
- Archived upstream (kept — still reference-quality): [hacker-roadmap](https://github.com/sundowndev/hacker-roadmap)
- Quiet classics (no push in 2+ years, still the standard): hacker-roadmap, SecuriBench Micro
- Youngest entries: Android Security Awesome (2014), Infosec Reference (2014), SecuriBench Micro (2014)

TOP TOOLS BY GITHUB STARS



MOST FORKED — REAL-WORLD REUSE SIGNAL



THE NEWCOMERS — NEWEST ARRIVALS

hacker-roadmap	2018
SecuriBench Micro	2014
Android Security Awesome	2014

QUIET CLASSICS — STILL THE STANDARD

hacker-roadmap, SecuriBench Micro

Tools with no recent push that remain the community's default reference for their job.

LANGUAGE MIX — GITHUB-HOSTED ENTRIES



CREATION ERAS — WHEN THIS REALM WAS BUILT



First-seen on GitHub, bucketed by decade.

HOW TO READ A DOSSIER

Each heavyweight gets a full dossier: live GitHub census (stars, forks, first-release year, last push, license, language), the project's own claim, our curator's note, a signal check, and its star weight against the realm's #1. Numbers are pulled straight from the GitHub API on 2026-10-17 — no self-reported marketing figures, only what the platforms show.

THE CENSUS METRICS — WHAT EACH NUMBER MEANS

★ GitHub stars
Community trust signal — how many developers bookmarked the repo.

Forks · reuse
Real-world deployment signal — forks mean people build on it.

First developed
Year the repo first appeared on GitHub — the project's true age.

Last push
Most recent code push — the project's heartbeat.

License
What you may legally do with it. MIT/Apache = permissive.

2026 momentum
Shipped code during 2026 — active development, not abandonware.

THE ROSTER — PROFILED THIS EDITION

RANK 01
hacker-roadmap
15.7k ★ · since 2018

RANK 02
Android Security Awesome
9.8k ★ · since 2014

RANK 03
PayloadsAllTheThings
— ★ · since 2016

RANK 04
GTFOBins
— ★ · since 2018

RANK 05
OWASP MSTG
— ★ · since 2016

RANK 06
HackTricks
— ★ · since 2020

METHODOLOGY & PROVENANCE

Census pulled via the GitHub REST API on 2026-10-17; realm curation and curator's notes by the Awesome Cyber Security Heaven maintainers; field-intelligence summaries synthesized by seed-2-0-mini from the same census. Everything reproducible — every figure traces back to a public API response. Released under CC0.

01 Hacker Roadmap

github.com/sundowndev/hacker-roadmap

● QUIET CLASSIC

★ 15.7k	1.7k	2018	2023-10	MIT	—
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

8	3	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (HACKER-ROADMAP · 15.7K)

REUSE SIGNAL

11.0% fork-to-star ratio — healthy reuse.

ISSUE HEALTH

3 open — lean queue.

LONGEVITY

8 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“A collection of hacking tools, resources and references to practice ethical hacking.”

● CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

A collection of hacking tools, resources and references to practice ethical hacking.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Academy · realm rank #1 by adoption

02 Android Security Awesome

github.com/ashishb/android-security-awesome

● ACTIVE 2026

★ 9.8k	1.6k	2014	2026-10	Apache-2.0	Makefile
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

12	0	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (HACKER-ROADMAP · 15.7K)

REUSE SIGNAL

16.2% fork-to-star ratio — high operational reuse.

ISSUE HEALTH

0 open — lean queue.

LONGEVITY

12 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● **THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT**

“A collection of android security related resources”

● **CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE**

A collection of android security related resources

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Academy · realm rank #2 by adoption

03 PayloadsAllTheThings

github.com/swisskyrepo/PayloadsAllTheThings

● ACTIVE 2026

★ —	—	2016	2026-08	—	—
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

10	—	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (HACKER-ROADMAP · 15.7K)

REUSE SIGNAL
— fork-to-star ratio — reference-grade adoption.

ISSUE HEALTH
—.

LONGEVITY
10 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● **THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT**

“A list of useful payloads and bypass for Web Application Security and Pentest/CTF”

● **CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE**

A list of useful payloads and bypass for Web Application Security and Pentest/CTF

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Academy · realm rank #3 by adoption

04 GTFOBins

github.com/GTFOBins/GTFOBins.github.io

● ACTIVE 2026

★ —	—	2018	2026-05	—	—
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

8	—	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (HACKER-ROADMAP · 15.7K)

REUSE SIGNAL

— fork-to-star ratio — reference-grade adoption.

ISSUE HEALTH

—.

LONGEVITY

8 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“GTFOBins is a curated list of Unix-like executables that can be used to bypass local security restrictions in”

● CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

GTFOBins is a curated list of Unix-like executables that can be used to bypass local security restrictions in

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Academy · realm rank #4 by adoption

05 OWASP MSTG

github.com/OWASP/owasp-mstg

● ACTIVE 2026

★ —	—	2016	2026-10	—	—
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

10	—	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (HACKER-ROADMAP · 15.7K)

REUSE SIGNAL

— fork-to-star ratio — reference-grade adoption.

ISSUE HEALTH

—.

LONGEVITY

10 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“The OWASP Mobile Application Security Testing Guide (MASTG) is a comprehensive manual for mobile app security”

● CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

The OWASP Mobile Application Security Testing Guide (MASTG) is a comprehensive manual for mobile app security

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Academy · realm rank #5 by adoption

06 HackTricks

github.com/HackTricks-wiki/hacktricks

● ACTIVE 2026

★ —	—	2020	2026-10	—	—
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

6	—	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (HACKER-ROADMAP · 15.7K)

REUSE SIGNAL

— fork-to-star ratio — reference-grade adoption.

ISSUE HEALTH

—.

LONGEVITY

6 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“Welcome to the page where you will find each trick/technique/whatever I have learnt in CTFs, real life apps, a”

● CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Welcome to the page where you will find each trick/technique/whatever I have learnt in CTFs, real life apps, a

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Academy · realm rank #6 by adoption

The complete curated inventory for this realm — flagship picks marked ★. Stars and activity chips reflect the 2026-10-17 census.

PayloadsAllTheThings ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 81.8k | since 2016

the curated payload and methodology repo — copy, paste, understand, learn.

github.com/swisskyrepo/PayloadsAllTheThings

hacker-roadmap ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 15.7k | since 2018

the illustrated cybersecurity study/career roadmap; the "where do I start?" answer.

github.com/sundowndev/hacker-roadmap

GTFOBins ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 13.7k | since 2018 | GPL-3.0

the living Linux binary-abuse matrix; the privilege-escalation bible.

github.com/GTFOBins/GTFOBins.github.io

OWASP MSTG ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 13.3k | since 2016

the Mobile Security Testing Guide: the canonical methodology for mobile app assessments. (CC-BY-SA-4.0)

github.com/OWASP/owasp-mstg

HackTricks ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 12.6k | since 2020 | free; custom content license

the pentester's playbook: technique-by-technique attack references from recon to post-exploitation.

github.com/HackTricks-wiki/hacktricks

Android Security Awesome ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 9.8k | since 2014 | Apache-2.0, curated list | active 2026

curated Android security research: tools, papers and training.

github.com/ashishb/android-security-awesome

LOLBAS

★ 8.9k | since 2018 | GPL-3.0

the Windows counterpart to GTFOBins: living-off-the-land binaries and scripts.

github.com/LOLBAS-Project/LOLBAS

Infosec Reference

★ 6.0k | since 2014 | curated list

the giant information-security reference: tools, papers and guides in one place.

github.com/rmusser01/Infosec_Reference

Network Segmentation Cheat Sheet

★ 3.5k | since 2021 | Apache-2.0

practical segmentation architecture: VLANs, zones and rules that survive audits.

github.com/sergiomarotco/Network-segmentation-cheat-sheet

SecuriBench Micro

★ 27 | since 2014 | Apache-2.0

the Stanford benchmark suite for security-analysis tools.

github.com/too4words/securibench-micro/

PortSwigger Web Security Academy

free, best-in-class web-hacking labs from the Burp Suite team; the standard web-security curriculum.

portswigger.net/web-security

OWASP WSTG

the Web Security Testing Guide — the methodology standard for thorough assessments.

owasp.org/www-project-web-security-testing-guide/

OWASP Cheat Sheet Series

concise, developer-friendly defensive guidance per topic; the fix side of every finding.

cheatsheetseries.owasp.org/

Professor Messer

free complete video courses for Security+, Network+ and CySA+; the default free cert-prep resource.

professormesser.com

pwn.college

ASU's free hands-on curriculum from Linux basics to kernel exploitation, with dojo challenges.

pwn.college

IppSec

the legendary HTB walkthrough archive; watch a master work through every box, searchable by technique.

ippsec.rocks

LiveOverflow

deep-dive security videos that explain *why* things break — the channel every hacker watched.

Hacker101

HackerOne's free web-security course: video lessons plus an always-on CTF for bug-bounty practice.

Hacksplaining

interactive security lessons for developers: exploit each vulnerability class, then patch it yourself.

hacksplaining.com/

Hoppers Academy

free structured courses from computing fundamentals to security — the patient beginner's path.

hoppersroppers.org/

SEED Labs

the university-grade lab curriculum: hundreds of hands-on exercises for every security course topic.

seedsecuritylabs.org/

CTF Field Guide

Trail of Bits' field guide to capture-the-flag: from fundamentals to finals. (CC-BY-4.0)

trailofbits.github.io/ctf/

Bug Bounty Hunter

free service

free bug-bounty training platform: real methodology and lab targets.

bugbountyhunter.com/

Cyber Security Base

free course

free course series by Aalto University and F-Secure; from beginner to blue team.

cybersecuritybase.github.io/



End of inventory — 24 curated entries in The Academy

Census 2026-10-17 · every entry human-curated · stars and activity verified against the live GitHub API.
Thirteen more realm dossiers — Armory, Bastion, Watchtower and friends — live in the same repository.

Awesome Cyber Security Heaven

438 FREE TOOLS · 14 REALMS · ONE CURATED HEAVEN

This dossier covered **The Academy**.

Thirteen more realm dossiers wait in the same repository — Armory, Bastion, Watchtower, Cartographers, Shadow Bureau, Vault, Foundry, Sentinel Ops, Oracle's Domain, AI Forge, Free Bazaar, Academy, Proving Grounds and Workshop.

438	14	CC0
CURATED TOOLS	REALM DOSSIERS	LICENSE

github.com/RanaKhan77/awesome-cyber-security-heaven

Free forever · community-curated · 2026-10-17 census